

MANÖVER

(MANOEUVRE)

The gameboard is by the midfold through the dashed blue and red lines, “Gränsen” (the border), split into two “countries” – the blue and the red.

The blue “country” has 44 blue *small* pieces = “footmen” as well as 12 *larger* blue = “riders”. The red “country” obtains the same amount of red pieces.

The objective of the game is that by means of advancing the pieces, “army”, obtain a (in “enemy territory”) continuous front, preferably as far as possible inside “enemy territory” as possible, and that cannot be breached by the enemy, thereby in part conquering as large a territory (number of squares) as possible from the opponent, in part conquering as many pieces as possible (by surrounding them).

“Kvarnbäcken” (The mill creek) may only be crossed by the bridges, and the “houses” may only be passed through by the openings. Pieces may be moved straight or diagonally in all directions. The protrusions by certain house entrances and some bridge foundations (i.e. by Torpet (the croft) or Spången (the footbridge)) means that one may not not move diagonally there.

GAME RULES.

1. Sides are determined by drawing lots. The lead turn is taken by the red force.
2. Either side has disposal over 12 riders (larger piece) and 44 foot soldiers (smaller piece).
3. The pieces are moved either along the rowlines (straight ahead), or across the rows (diagonally).
4. A rider may be moved from 1 to 10 squares per turn.
5. A footsoldier may only be moved from 1 up to 6 squares per turn.
6. Several riders may be moved simultaneously, but the total movement may not exceed 10 squares.
7. The same holds true for the foot soldiers, though then only 6 squares altogether.
8. A rider and footsoldier may be moved simultaneously, but then no more than 6 squares.
9. A square, that has been occupied by the opponent, may not be passed through.
10. A rider may pass through a square, that has been occupied by own pieces.
11. A footsoldier may however only pass through a square, where *an own foot soldier* stands. (May therefore not pass through an own rider.)
12. A piece (or pieces) is lost, when it (they) is surrounded thus by the opponent, that it cannot be moved anywhere. It is then removed from the game. Houses and bridges must be fully occupied, before the occupants are lost, i.e. a couple of pieces inside of a house are not lost, by the fact that enemy forces has occupied all the openings. The enemy must enter the house and push the occupants into a corner, so that they there can no longer “move”.
13. The game progresses, until both forces stand in position against each other, so that no further terrain conquests can be made. Either side has then created a front line, that cannot be breached by either side – “a stagnated trench warfare has emerged”.
14. Thereafter both sides sum up the number of *enemy* squares within the by their own forces occupied area, and each square counts for 1 point.
15. A captured rider counts for 6 points.
16. A captured foot soldier counts for 2 points.
17. If sole enemy pieces should lie behind the own front – when the game is finished – are these considered captured without being directly surrounded and give the same points as in 14 and 15.
18. Exceptions herefrom are for example a house where the entrances are barred by the enemy soldiers: the enemy then scores the points for all squares within the house.
19. The side, that has the most points, has won.

COMMON INSTRUCTIONS.

All square that partly belong to the creek or lake, are considered a full square. Observe carefully those positions, where figures may be moved diagonally through these small squares!

The red force, that always opens the game, should primarily make sure of the bridges, and make it so, that free passage exists over at least Kvarnbron (the mill bridge) and preferably also Spången – the opponent should therefore seek to hinder this.

Observe that, in order for passage to be secured across Spången and Gamla bron (the old bridge), the piece should occupy the square on the other side of the creek and not on the bridge! If it occupies the bridge, the opponent only needs to place a piece by the bridge foundation to bar the crossing. Observe the protrusions by certain bridges!

By Kvarnbron however 4 pieces are needed for barring, as one there may move diagonally out from the bridge, as it does not reach into the land area. It thusly lack protrusions. C.f. the house entrances!

The game is not complete, until a front line has been established, such that the forces can no longer pass each other. As soon as the fronts are stable, i.e. no piece in the frontline may be moved without a gap occurring, that can be exploited by the enemy, *the game is aborted and the scoring commences*.

Should own pieces succeed in occupying all entrances to a house on enemy territory, all the house squares count as won. Any connection to own troops is not needed, and the house cannot be retaken, unless enemy pieces are trapped within the house, so that they may attack the defenders into the rear as well as from the outside. Because of their fortified position in this case, these are not counted as pieces captured behind the front, when the game is finished, instead any surrounded and occupied squares count towards the attacker.

It is thus of importance to occupy the house entrances. Especially the blue force should occupy Storgården (the large farm), so that free passage exists through this.

The piece set up at the game start is free. Naturally one places the riders in the front and start the game with these. As the first square is the outmost squares of the depot (depå) counted, i.e. pieces from the inner parts of the depot may without counting be moved straight ahead – but *not* diagonally – within the depot area to the its outer squares.

It is beneficial during the game to relieve riders from positions in a locked down frontline and replace these with infantry. The greater mobility of the riders is then exploited in new manoeuvres.

The pieces' missions and the basics of gameplay can be further explained by the following example: Suppose, that the blue force has advanced its pieces into the farthest (as seen from the blue country) entrance of Brogården (the bridge farm), as well as 1 piece in every square towards Torpet and in the farthest (as seen from the blue country) entrance of Torpet. Blue has thus gained a stable line of attack, and if red on the blue area shall try for a similar manoeuvre, he can not cross into blue land other than by going either to the left of Torpet or right of Brogården. (We here suppose, that the passage over Gamla bron and around the lake already have been sealed.) Such an attack can not be too effective considering the long way red has to travel. The red force should therefore off course in due time insert a "wedge", where the blue force aims to extend its front.

The game is suitable as a game "all against all", whereas the final scores can be noted and the "quota" determines skill.

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[Key to mapboard locations: Depå för röd styrka (depot for the red force), Kvarnen (the mill), Spången (the foot bridge), Kvarnbron (the mill bridge), Kvarnbäcken (the mill creek), Brogården (the bridge farm), Torpet (the croft). Depå för blå styrka (depot for the blue force), Storgården (the large farm), Kvarnsjön (the mill lake), Gamla bron (the old bridge).]

DEPÅ FÖR BLÅ STYRKA

KVARNEN

STORGÅRDEN

KVARNEN

BROGÅRDEN

TORPET

KVARNBRON

KVARNEN

DEPÅ FÖR RÖD STYRKA

SPÅNGEN